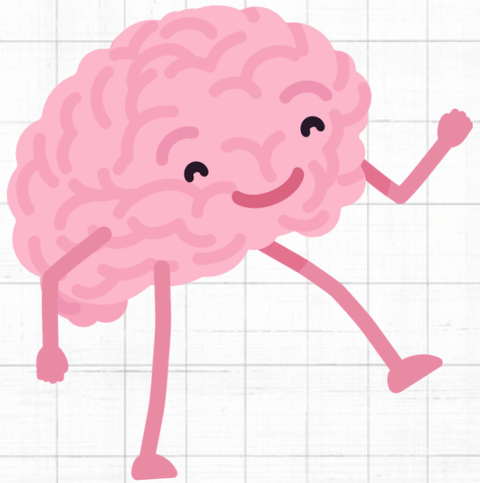
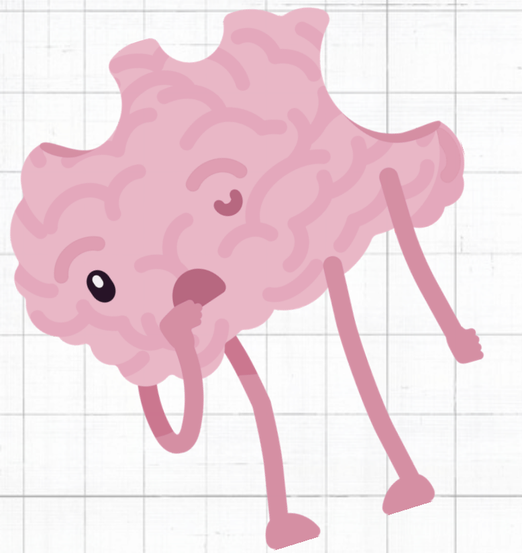
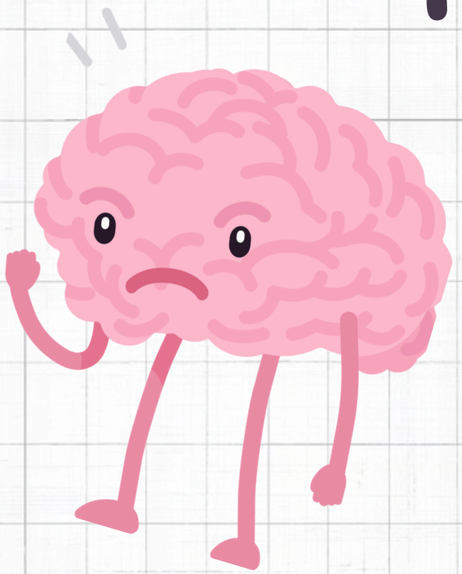


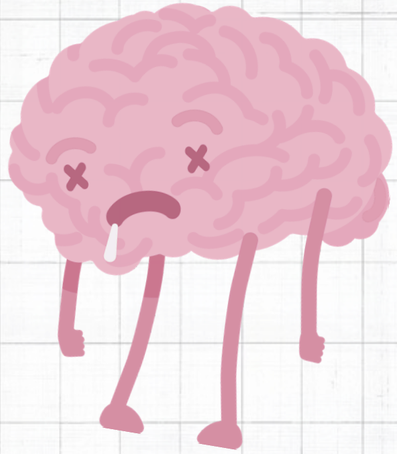




MENTAL HEALTH & TIME MANAGEMENT







NextInResearch 2026

TODAY'S AGENDA:

- REWIRE YOUR BRAIN
- RELAX

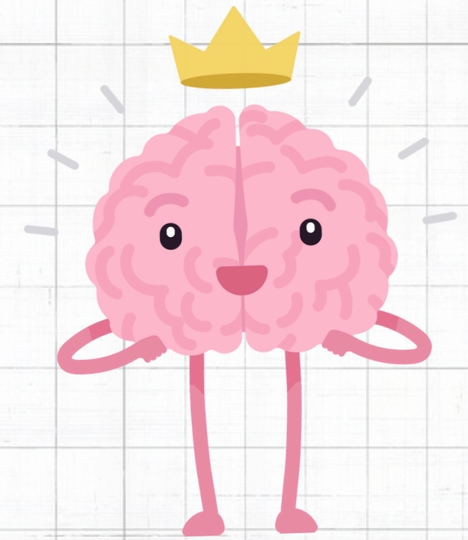
UNDERSTAND YOUR MIND

- Having neuroplasticity on your side
  - “I think, therefore I am” - René Descartes, Philosopher
- Reframe how you think (no right way of thinking!)
  - Nervousness vs. “Inner applause”
  - Stress vs. Caring
  - you’re not like anyone else vs. there’s only one of you



GOALS AND PURPOSE

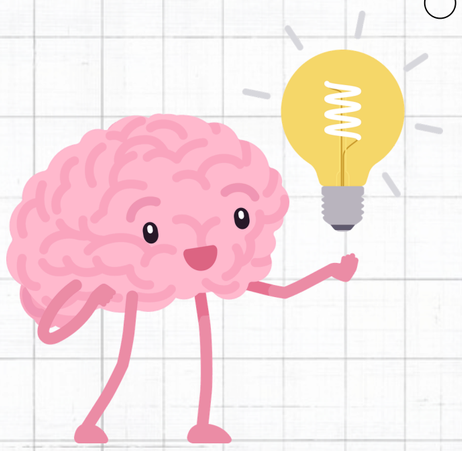
- Set your initial goals, and there you will find your purpose
- Ikigai “outline”: japenese word that means ”reason for being”
    - Four Core Elements:
        - What you love
        - What you are good at
        - What the world needs
        - What you can get paid for

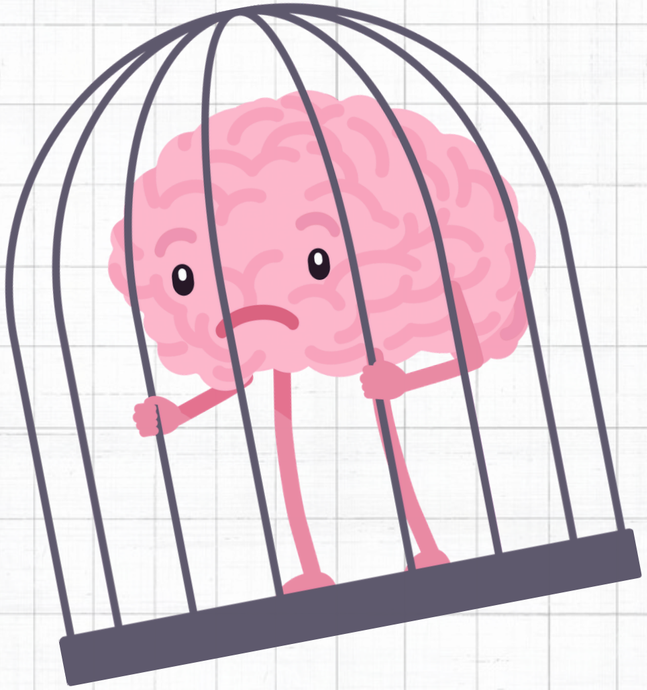




FIND WHAT MOTIVATES YOU:

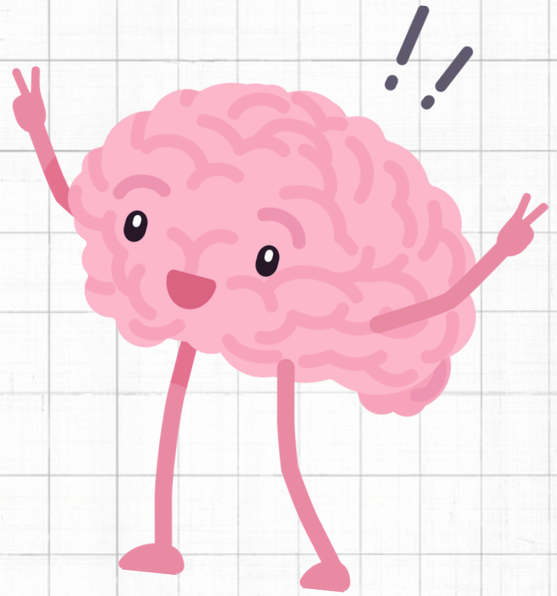
- Small things?
  - Quotes (like the ones in this slideshow)!
  - Hype gym song
- Large things?
  - Your story, who you want to become
  - What you want to accomplish

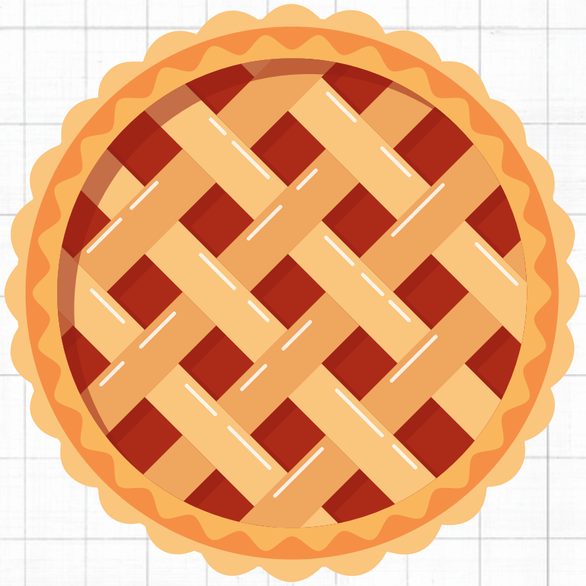




FUN ACTIVITY

Pie a mentor!

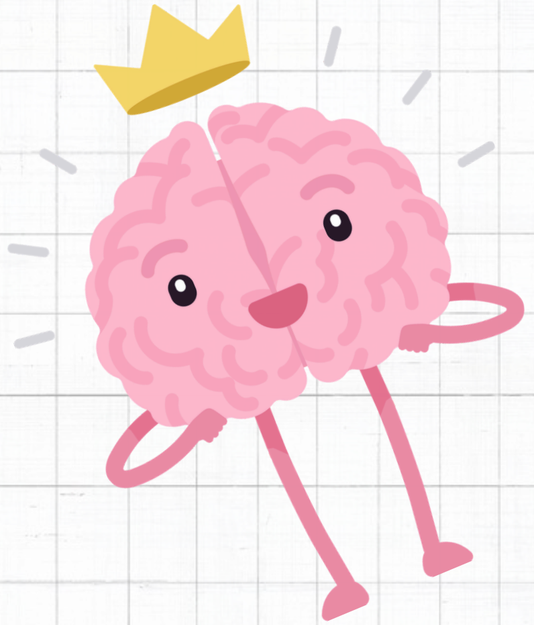


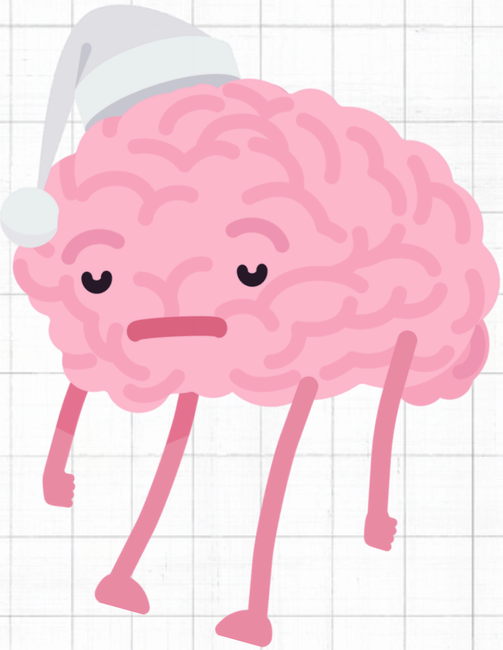


"MANAGEMENT" STARTER PACK: SCHOOL, SUCCEEDING, AND WELLBEING

SCHOOL + GRADES (GENERAL):

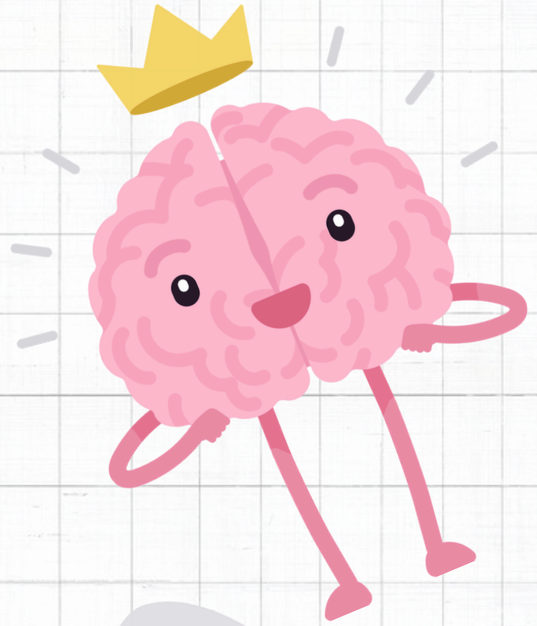
- Love what you learn (& make it fun!)
- Don't rely on your memory to complete tasks
    - Use a digital planner or old-school paper planner
- Connect with new people --> you can learn something from everyone

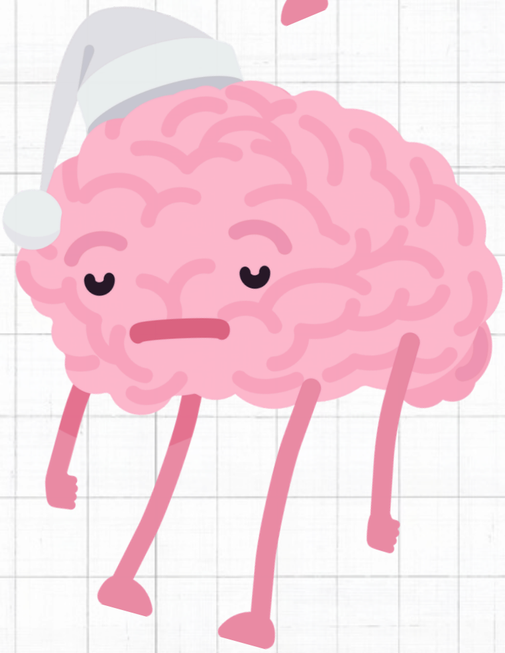




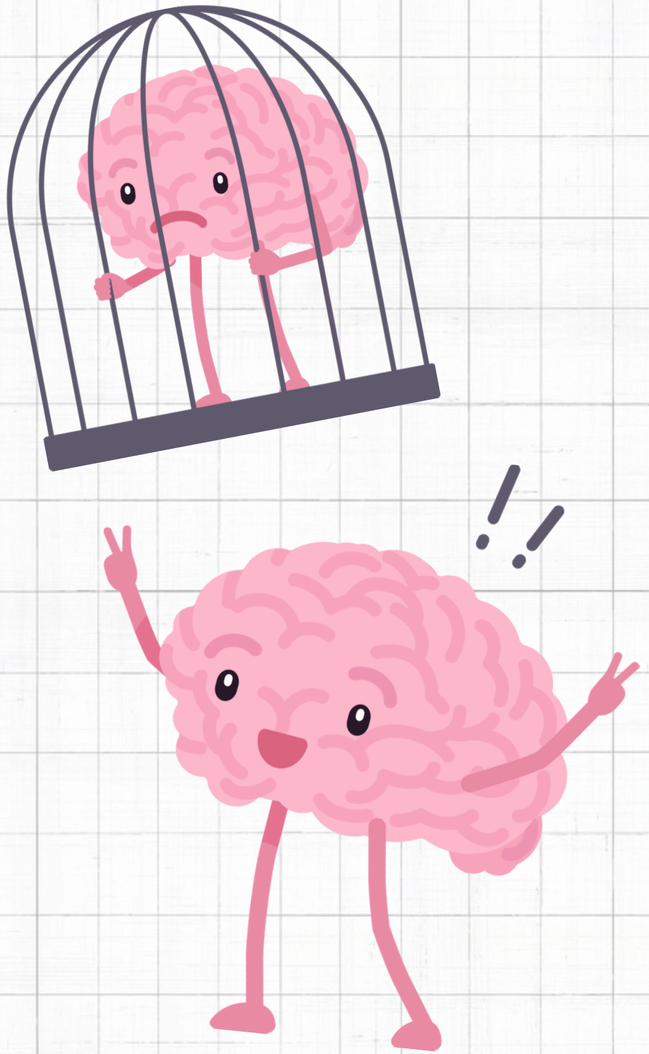
SCHOOL + GRADES (& BEYOND):

- Find ways to stand out, not just by getting getting good grades
    - Forming your own way of thinking & disagreeing → “should schools allow this book” example
    - Ask questions
        - “A well-educated mind will always have more questions than answers.” — Helen Keller
- If you like something, take it to the next level
    - Ex: You like making clothes → collaborate with designers and create something





FUN ACTIVITY



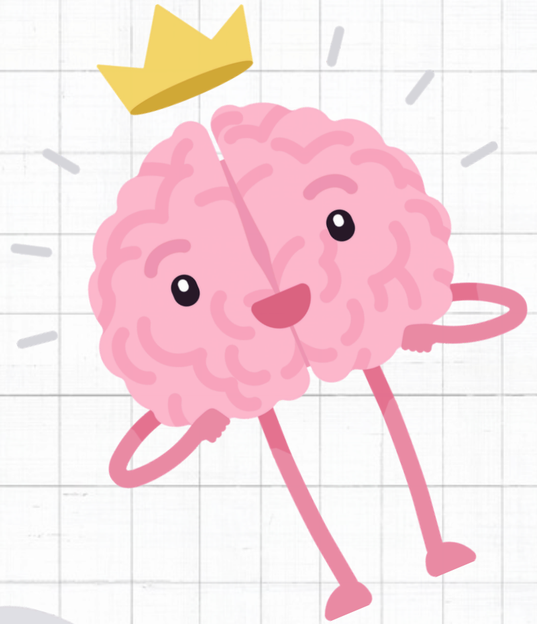
Coloring telephone!
For each group of tables, we will give the person closest to the middle a phrase that they must draw out. The next person will have to guess, and draw their own version, and so on until the end of the row.

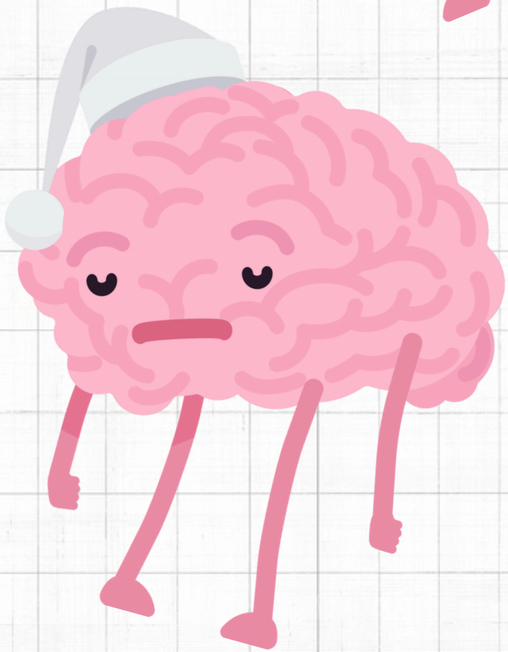
The last person will draw and try to GUESS the phrase, and we will reveal original phrases!

EXERCISE & PHONES:

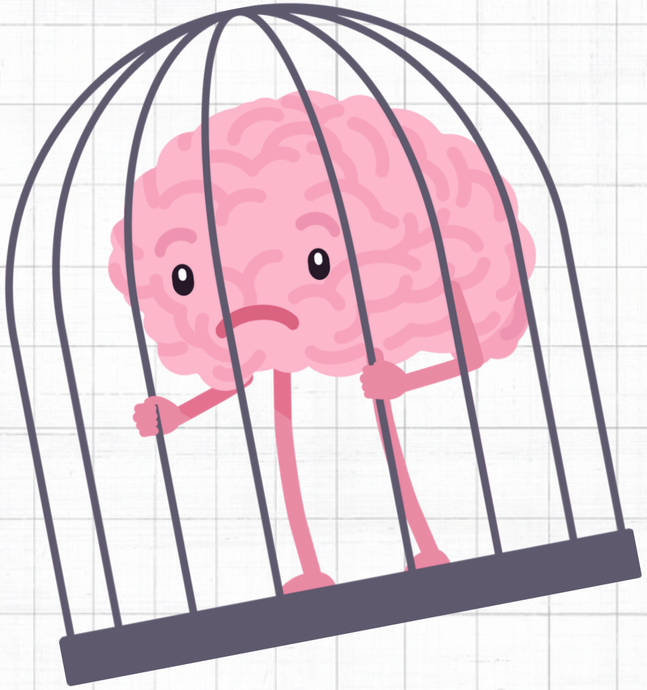
- 60 minutes of exercise a day - It actually works!
- Playing a sport, lifting weights, eating healthy

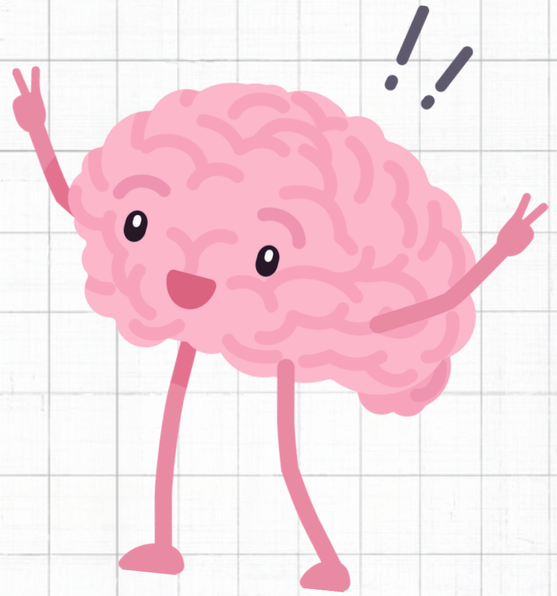






- STOP Doomscrolling! Social media is the biggest killer of mental health, grades, and time.
- Different people have different opinions: trial and error.

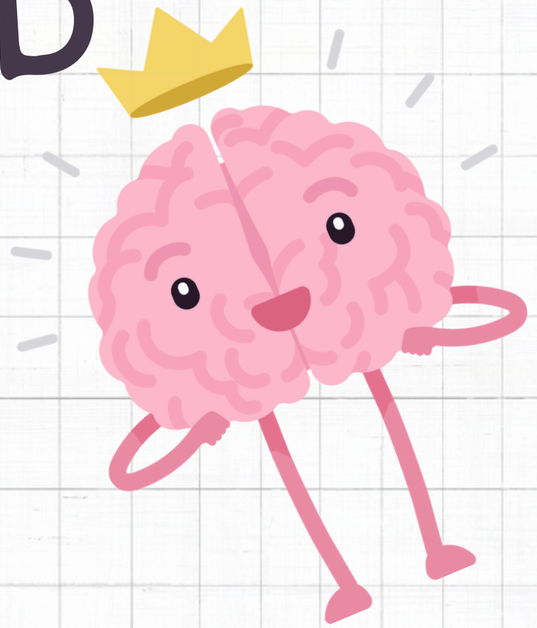




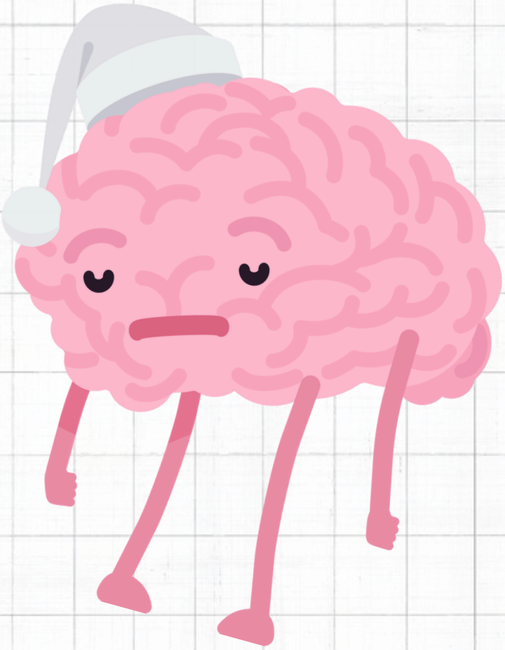
FUN ACTIVITY/ CHALLENGE

Who can do more pushups than Ishaan?

STUDY METHODS: FIND WHAT WORKS FOR YOU



- Pomodoro (30 minute study, 5 minute break, repeat)
    - Good for focus & rapid-fire work/busy work

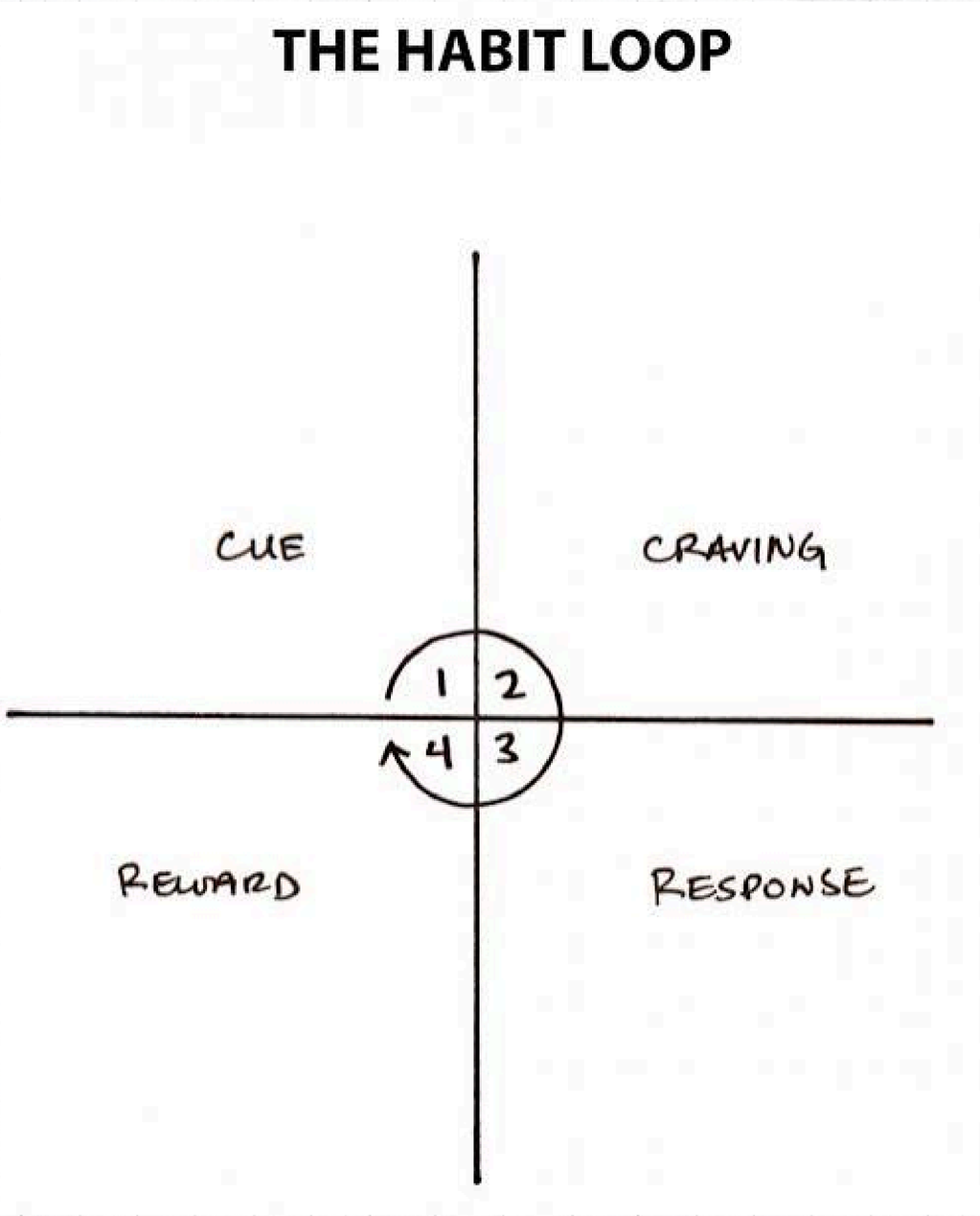


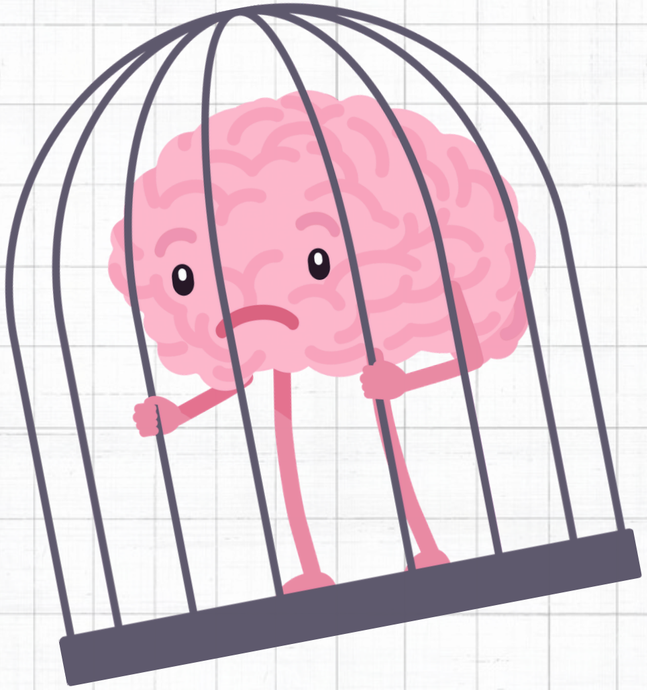
- Make a to-do list, and check tasks off as you go (internal reward system)
- Give your mom your phone
- Don't procrastinate: do it now and have fun later

BUILD HABITS

- Maurya's QuestIRL app (Survey)

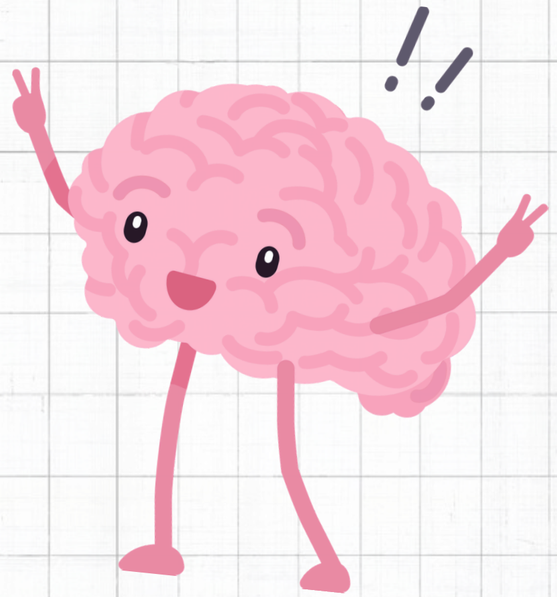
- Strong habits save mental energy, turning it into routine. Take advantage of this!

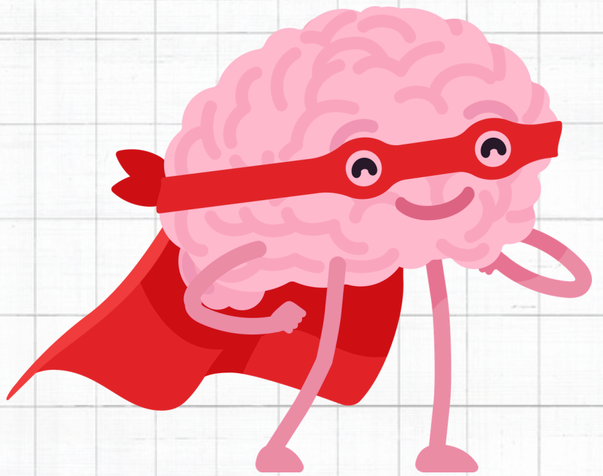




FINAL FUN ACTIVITY

ESCAPE ROOM!





THANK YOU!